PROJECT REPORT: DIGITAL LITERACY (CSE0001)

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Introduction

This project was undertaken as part of the Digital Literacy course, where I acted in the capacity of a Student Digital Ambassador. The primary objective of this role is to assist peers in navigating the digital landscape safely, professionally, and efficiently. This report documents the completion of five critical tasks designed to establish a foundational digital footprint. These tasks range from visual communication and professional networking on platforms like LinkedIn and GitHub to practicing coding on HackerRank and understanding the nuances of cybersecurity. The resulting portfolio serves as a permanent record of my digital skills and professional readiness.

Task 1: Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic

For this task, I designed a one-page visual resource aimed at explaining the core concepts of Digital Literacy to my batchmates. I utilized **Canva** to create the infographic due to its intuitive design tools and professional templates. The infographic covers three essential pillars: safe internet practices, professional online presence, and useful digital tools for students.

The most interesting aspect of this task was learning how to present complex information visually using icons and brief bullet points rather than long paragraphs. I found it slightly challenging to ensure the layout remained balanced and readable, but using a grid system in Canva helped maintain a clean aesthetic. This exercise highlighted the importance of visual communication in effectively reaching a large audience.

Task 2: Student Digital Portfolio

A professional digital presence is essential for modern career opportunities. For this task, I established and optimized my profiles on **GitHub, LinkedIn, and HackerRank**.

- **GitHub:** This platform serves as my primary version control tool for hosting academic projects and collaborating on code.
- **LinkedIn:** I use this for professional networking, connecting with faculty, and tracking industry trends.
- **HackerRank:** This is my dedicated environment for practicing problem-solving and refining my programming logic.

Over the next four years, I plan to use these platforms as a "living resume." I will consistently push my coursework to GitHub, update my LinkedIn with new certifications and internship experiences, and maintain a coding streak on HackerRank to prepare for technical placements.

Task 3: Coding & Collaboration Platforms

This module focused on technical growth and collaborative digital tools. I utilized **HackerRank** to complete the "Solve Me First" challenge, which verified my understanding of basic programming syntax and logic. These platforms are invaluable for academic success as they provide immediate feedback through automated test cases.

Additionally, I created a **Google Form** titled "Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz" consisting of five questions. This task demonstrated the ease of collecting data and managing collaborative feedback through the Google Workspace ecosystem. I linked the form to a Google Sheet to track responses, a skill that will be highly beneficial for future team projects and research data collection.

Task 4: Professional Email & Etiquette Guide

Professional communication is a vital soft skill. For this task, I drafted two professional emails: one requesting an assignment extension from a professor and another expressing interest in an internship. These drafts emphasize clear subject lines, formal greetings, and a structured body.

I researched a scenario where a student’s casual tone in an email led to a misunderstanding with a coordinator, resulting in a lost opportunity. This taught me that professional communication is about clarity and respect. Using "text-speak" or omitting a clear subject line can cause messages to be misinterpreted or ignored. This task reinforced that adapting my communication style to the audience is key to professional success.

Task 5: Cybercrime Awareness & Prevention

While researching **Phishing** for my case study, I was surprised to learn how sophisticated and targeted modern attacks have become, often masquerading as legitimate university or banking notifications. I learned that attackers rely heavily on creating a false sense of urgency to bypass a person's critical thinking.

As a result of this research, I have committed to changing my personal digital habits by enabling **Two-Factor Authentication (2FA)** across all my accounts and being more skeptical of unsolicited links. Being a Digital Ambassador means setting a standard for security that others can follow, and I will now prioritize verifying email senders before clicking any attachments.

Conclusion

This project has provided me with a comprehensive framework for navigating the digital world as a student and future professional. Through the creation of a digital portfolio and the exploration of various collaborative and technical platforms, I have gained the confidence to manage my online identity. I have learned that digital literacy is a continuous journey of learning and adaptation. I look forward to building upon this foundation throughout my degree at VIT Bhopal.

References

- GitHub Profile: https://github.com
- LinkedIn Profile: https://www.linkedin.com
- HackerRank Profile: https://www.hackerrank.com
- Canva Design Tools: https://canva.com